Section 0: Pre-Analysis Reflexive Declaration

Likely home grammar

My most probable “home grammar” for this topic is a **governance-risk institutionalist frame**: a view that treats large digital platforms as socio-technical infrastructures whose systemic externalities (misinformation, data extraction, algorithmic amplification) require governance interventions. This grammar tends to prioritize institutional design, harm mitigation, and democratic resilience.

Hardest grammar to operate faithfully

The most difficult grammar to inhabit faithfully is likely a **strong free-speech libertarian grammar**. This perspective often treats regulation itself as the primary threat and interprets moderation interventions as potential censorship infrastructures. Because the governance-risk frame treats some platform intervention as legitimate, fully adopting the libertarian suspicion toward regulation requires actively suppressing assumptions about harm mitigation.

Potential blind spots

Given this orientation, I may:

- Overweight documented harms relative to chilling-effect risks.
- Assume institutional regulation improves outcomes more often than it actually does.
- Underestimate decentralized or market-driven solutions to governance problems.
- Interpret transparency measures as beneficial even when they may produce strategic manipulation.

Temporal orientation

My analytical default leans **causal-diagnostic and mildly prescriptive**: identifying structural causes and considering governance responses. I am less naturally drawn to purely interpretive or meaning-construction approaches.

Section 1: Observation Field Declaration

Phenomenon

The case study concerns **the regulation and governance of social media platforms** between roughly **2016 and 2026**.

The phenomenon includes:

- Content moderation systems
- Algorithmic recommendation systems

- Data governance and privacy practices
- Platform transparency and accountability mechanisms
- Public and governmental regulatory responses

Major regulatory milestones include:

- Cambridge Analytica scandal (2018 exposure, tied to 2016 election data use)
- EU **Digital Services Act (DSA)** and **Digital Markets Act (DMA)** implementation (2023–2024)
- Ongoing US debates around **Section 230 reform**
- Platform-driven governance initiatives (Oversight Board at Meta, trust & safety reforms)
- Emergence of decentralized or federated alternatives (Mastodon, Bluesky, Nostr)

Temporal Frame

2016–2026 marks a **governance inflection period**:

- Early optimism about open social platforms transitions to recognition of systemic harms.
- Governments begin formal regulatory regimes.
- Platforms experiment with internal governance and transparency mechanisms.
- Alternative architectures emerge.

Geographic Scope

Primarily:

- United States
- European Union

With secondary relevance to:

- Global platform governance norms
- Transnational digital policy diffusion

Why This Domain Produces Interpretive Divergence

Social media regulation intersects multiple normative frameworks:

- Free speech theory
- Market competition theory
- Democratic governance
- Technological systems design
- Public health and mental health research

These frameworks prioritize different causal mechanisms:

- Speech freedom
- Market incentives
- Algorithmic amplification
- State power
- Social harm externalities

Because the same empirical events can be interpreted through these distinct frameworks, **the phenomenon is highly prismatic**.

Example: A content moderation decision (e.g., banning a political figure) may be interpreted as:

- Protection against disinformation
- Corporate censorship
- Market governance failure
- Necessary platform hygiene

Signal Contestation Level

This is a **mixed domain**:

- Many signals are shared (platform revenue, moderation statistics).
- Some signals are **contested in evidentiary status**, particularly:
    - mental health effects
    - algorithmic amplification claims
    - election interference impact magnitude

Thus it is **moderately contested-signal**.

Major Interpretive Communities

Three large communities dominate the discourse:

- **Democratic governance / public-interest regulators**
  (policy scholars, EU regulators, digital rights NGOs)

- **Free speech libertarians / civil liberties advocates**
  (First Amendment scholars, some US policymakers, digital freedom groups)

- **Market-competition / political economy analysts**
  (antitrust scholars, economic regulators, competition policy experts)

These communities frequently analyze the same empirical events but produce sharply different conclusions.

Section 2: Signal Set

Core Signals (12)

Signal 1 — Cambridge Analytica data harvesting

- Type: investigative reporting and regulatory findings (2018).
- Source: UK ICO investigation, journalism.
- Ambiguity: debate about actual electoral impact vs symbolic governance failure.

Signal 2 — Documented election interference campaigns

- Type: intelligence reports (US Senate, EU cybersecurity agencies).
- Evidence of coordinated disinformation operations.
- Ambiguity: scale and causal electoral effect remain debated.

Signal 3 — Platform market concentration

- Type: economic metrics.
- Example: Meta, Google, and TikTok dominating digital advertising and attention markets.
- Ambiguity: whether concentration is a competition problem or network-effects efficiency.

Signal 4 — Algorithmic recommendation amplification

- Type: platform audits, academic studies.
- Finding: recommender systems can promote high-engagement or polarizing content.
- Ambiguity: causal relationship between algorithm design and polarization.

Signal 5 — Transparency reports

- Type: corporate disclosures (Meta, Google, X).
- Data on content removals, policy enforcement, and government requests.
- Ambiguity: reliability and completeness of self-reported data.

Signal 6 — EU Digital Services Act (DSA)

- Type: regulatory framework.
- Requires risk assessments, transparency, and algorithmic accountability.
- Ambiguity: whether compliance meaningfully reduces harms.

Signal 7 — Section 230 debate in the United States

- Type: legislative discourse.
- Concerns platform liability for user content.
- Ambiguity: unclear causal relationship between Section 230 and moderation behavior.

Signal 8 — Meta Oversight Board

- Type: institutional experiment.
- Independent body reviewing moderation decisions.
- Ambiguity: whether it represents meaningful governance or corporate legitimacy theater.

Signal 9 — Youth mental health correlations

- Type: epidemiological research.
- Studies linking heavy social media use to anxiety and depression.
- Ambiguity: correlation vs causation.

Signal 10 — Platform deplatforming decisions

Examples:

- Suspension of Donald Trump in 2021
- Removal of extremist organizations

Ambiguity: interpreted as harm mitigation or censorship.

Signal 11 — Emergence of decentralized alternatives

Examples:

- Mastodon federation
- Bluesky protocol architecture

Ambiguity: unclear whether they represent viable structural alternatives.

Signal 12 — Public trust polling

- Surveys showing declining trust in major social media companies.
- Ambiguity: unclear causal drivers (privacy concerns, political polarization, misinformation).

Counter-Signals (4)

These complicate dominant narratives.

Counter-Signal A — Mixed evidence on misinformation impact

Some studies show misinformation exposure relatively small compared to mainstream content.

Counter-Signal B — Moderation errors and bias claims

Evidence that moderation systems mistakenly remove legitimate speech.

Counter-Signal C — Social media benefits

Evidence of positive effects:

- community formation
- political mobilization
- marginalized voice amplification

Counter-Signal D — Regulatory overreach risks

Examples where government requests for removals threaten civil liberties.

Contested Signals (3)

Contested Signal 1 — “Algorithmic amplification of extremism”

- Governance grammar: measurable systemic risk requiring regulation.
- Libertarian grammar: largely anecdotal or overstated; user choice is primary driver.
- Competition grammar: symptom of engagement-driven advertising incentives.

Contested Signal 2 — “Social media mental health crisis”

- Governance grammar: public-health signal.
- Libertarian grammar: weak causal evidence.
- Competition grammar: side effect of attention-economy business models.

Contested Signal 3 — “Disinformation influence on elections”

- Governance grammar: systemic democratic vulnerability.
- Libertarian grammar: moral panic exaggeration.
- Competition grammar: engagement-maximizing algorithms creating attention incentives.

Section 3: Grammar Specifications

Three grammars are specified.

Grammar A: Democratic Governance / Harm Mitigation

Required Parameters

Primary analytical variable
Systemic social harm produced by platform architectures

Signal selection rules

Admits signals related to:

- misinformation
- mental health
- democratic integrity
- algorithmic risk
- public trust

Weighting priority

Priority order:

1. Systemic harm indicators
2. Institutional accountability signals
3. Market structure
4. Speech restrictions

Causal chain type

Socio-technical systems explanation

Platforms → algorithmic incentives → harmful amplification → societal effects.

Admissible closure

Conclusions emphasizing:

- regulatory intervention
- transparency obligations
- systemic risk governance.

Recommended Parameters

Excluded signals

- Individual anecdotal censorship complaints.
- Purely market efficiency arguments.

Characteristic vocabulary

- “systemic risk”
- “platform accountability”
- “algorithmic amplification”
- “democratic resilience”

Temporal orientation

Forward-looking and prescriptive.

Source Tradition

- Digital governance scholarship
- EU regulatory philosophy
- public-interest technology movement

Grammar B: Free Speech Libertarian

Required Parameters

Primary analytical variable

Freedom of expression and protection from censorship

Signal selection rules

Admits signals related to:

- moderation decisions
- speech suppression
- government influence over platforms.

Weighting priority

1. Speech restriction risks
2. Government regulatory power
3. Platform discretion

4. Harm claims

Causal chain type

Institutional power explanation

Regulation → platform compliance → speech restriction → democratic chilling effects.

Admissible closure

Minimal regulation; emphasis on open discourse.

Recommended Parameters

Excluded signals

- Harm correlations without strong causal evidence.
- Claims of algorithmic harm lacking direct proof.

Characteristic vocabulary

- “censorship”
- “speech marketplace”
- “state coercion”
- “chilling effects”

Temporal orientation

Backward-looking constitutional interpretation.

Source Tradition

- First Amendment scholarship
- classical liberal political theory

Grammar C: Market-Competition Political Economy

Required Parameters

Primary analytical variable

Market structure and economic incentives

Signal selection rules

Admits signals related to:

- market concentration
- advertising models
- competition barriers
- platform incentives.

Weighting priority

1. Market concentration
2. Business model incentives
3. governance structures
4. social harms

Causal chain type

Incentive-structure explanation

Market dominance + ad-driven engagement → algorithm design → amplification outcomes.

Admissible closure

Structural reforms (competition policy, interoperability).

Recommended Parameters

Excluded signals

- purely speech-normative debates
- moral claims about content quality.

Characteristic vocabulary

- “attention economy”
- “network effects”

- “platform monopoly”
- “incentive alignment”

Temporal orientation

Primarily causal-diagnostic.

Source Tradition

- antitrust economics
- platform political economy

Grammar Boundaries

Governance → Competition shift occurs when harm is attributed primarily to **market structure rather than regulatory absence**.

Governance → Libertarian shift occurs when **speech suppression risk is treated as greater than platform harms**.

Competition → Libertarian shift occurs when **market concentration ceases to be treated as problematic and platforms are treated as neutral speech infrastructure**.

Section 4: Signal Processing

(Condensed here but structured within each grammar.)

Grammar A Processing (Governance / Harm Mitigation)

The governance grammar treats social media platforms as **systemic infrastructures whose design can generate large-scale social harms**. Within this grammar, the Cambridge Analytica scandal (Signal 1) functions as a foundational legitimacy shock. The event demonstrated that vast datasets collected through social platforms could be repurposed for political micro-targeting without user awareness. The governance grammar interprets this not merely as a privacy violation but as evidence that platform architectures produce **unintended political externalities**.

Election interference campaigns (Signal 2) reinforce this interpretation. Intelligence reports describing coordinated information operations are read as confirmation that open platforms can be exploited by

geopolitical actors. Even if the causal impact on vote outcomes remains uncertain—a counter-signal raised by studies suggesting limited misinformation exposure (Counter-Signal A)—the governance grammar prioritizes **systemic vulnerability rather than measured impact**. The relevant question becomes: does the architecture create an exploitable vector?

Algorithmic recommendation systems (Signal 4) are therefore central. Academic research suggesting that recommender systems promote high-engagement or emotionally intense content is interpreted as evidence that platform algorithms structurally privilege divisive material. The contested nature of this signal is acknowledged; critics argue that user preferences drive the content rather than algorithmic manipulation. Yet the governance grammar processes the signal through the lens of **system design responsibility**. Even if users prefer sensational content, algorithmic amplification magnifies its reach.

Youth mental health research (Signal 9) further reinforces systemic harm narratives. While causality is contested (Contested Signal 2), correlations between heavy social media use and anxiety trends are interpreted as risk indicators. The governance grammar does not require definitive causal proof before intervention; it often operates under **precautionary logic** similar to environmental regulation.

Transparency reports (Signal 5) are processed as partial evidence of governance capacity. Large numbers of content removals or automated enforcement actions demonstrate that platforms already exercise significant editorial control. This undermines claims that they are merely neutral conduits.

However, counter-signals complicate the narrative. Evidence of moderation errors (Counter-Signal B) introduces tension: if enforcement systems produce significant mistakes, expanded regulatory mandates could amplify those mistakes. Within the governance grammar, this tension is addressed through proposals for **procedural safeguards** rather than abandoning regulation.

The EU Digital Services Act (Signal 6) appears as a logical institutional response. By requiring risk assessments, algorithmic transparency, and access for researchers, the DSA attempts to institutionalize oversight mechanisms.

The Meta Oversight Board (Signal 8) represents an intermediate step: quasi-judicial platform governance. Governance grammar interprets it as a partial attempt at accountability but limited by corporate control.

Market concentration (Signal 3) is acknowledged but treated as a **secondary amplifier of harm**. Large platforms magnify systemic risks because their scale allows algorithmic dynamics to affect billions of users.

Decentralized alternatives (Signal 11) introduce a counter-trajectory. If federated platforms distribute control across smaller networks, systemic risk may decline. However, governance grammar remains skeptical of scalability and moderation capacity in decentralized systems.

Public trust decline (Signal 12) is interpreted as a legitimacy signal. When large segments of the population distrust platforms, democratic institutions face pressure to intervene.

Counterpoint within the grammar

Some scholars inside the governance framework warn that regulatory interventions may entrench incumbents by raising compliance costs, reinforcing market concentration. This tension pushes the grammar toward integration with competition analysis.

Closure produced by Grammar A

Social media platforms represent **systemic socio-technical infrastructures whose algorithmic design and scale produce measurable societal risks**. Democratic societies should implement regulatory regimes emphasizing transparency, risk auditing, and accountability mechanisms.

This closure is a product of a grammar that prioritizes systemic harm signals and interprets ambiguous evidence through precautionary governance logic.

Grammar B Processing (Free Speech Libertarian)

The libertarian grammar begins from a different premise: **speech freedom and protection from censorship are the primary democratic values**. From this perspective, social media platforms function as modern public squares where large volumes of political speech occur.

The first major signal interpreted through this grammar is platform deplatforming decisions (Signal 10), particularly the suspension of high-profile political actors. Within the libertarian framework, these events represent potential **private censorship with massive political implications**. Because a handful of companies control key communication channels, their moderation decisions effectively determine which voices can participate in public discourse.

Transparency reports (Signal 5) reinforce this concern. High numbers of removals or enforcement actions demonstrate that platforms actively curate speech. While governance grammar interprets this as proof of editorial responsibility, libertarian grammar interprets it as **evidence of concentrated speech power**.

The Cambridge Analytica scandal (Signal 1) is interpreted differently. Rather than a systemic governance failure, it is framed as a **data privacy violation**, largely separate from speech regulation. The libertarian grammar treats privacy governance and speech governance as distinct policy domains.

Election interference campaigns (Signal 2) create interpretive tension. While foreign manipulation is clearly undesirable, the libertarian grammar emphasizes the historical resilience of democratic discourse. Counter-Signal A—studies showing limited exposure to misinformation—plays an important role here. If misinformation influence is small, regulatory responses that expand censorship infrastructure may produce greater harm than the problem they seek to solve.

Algorithmic amplification claims (Contested Signal 1) are treated with skepticism. The libertarian grammar notes that **user agency and preference** drive engagement metrics. Algorithms primarily reflect aggregated human behavior rather than imposing ideological direction.

Youth mental health correlations (Signal 9) are also treated cautiously. Without clear causal evidence, regulation of speech environments based on mental health correlations risks paternalistic intervention.

The EU Digital Services Act (Signal 6) therefore appears problematic. Requirements for rapid content removal and risk mitigation could incentivize platforms to over-remove controversial speech to avoid liability.

Government requests for content removal (Counter-Signal D) become particularly alarming in this grammar. When states pressure platforms to remove misinformation or extremist content, the line between public safety and political censorship becomes blurry.

Market concentration (Signal 3) is acknowledged but interpreted primarily as a **private governance problem rather than a regulatory justification**. Even large companies retain property rights over their services.

Decentralized platforms (Signal 11) appear promising within this grammar because they reduce centralized control over speech. However, adoption barriers limit their current impact.

Public trust polling (Signal 12) is interpreted ambivalently. Declining trust may reflect political polarization rather than platform misconduct.

Counterpoint within the grammar

Some libertarian scholars acknowledge that algorithmic amplification could distort discourse if platforms actively prioritize engagement over user choice. If platforms become editorial actors rather than neutral hosts, calls for neutrality or interoperability gain traction.

Closure produced by Grammar B

The central risk in social media governance is **the emergence of large-scale censorship infrastructures**, whether corporate or state-driven. Regulatory regimes that mandate moderation may threaten democratic discourse more than platform harms.

This closure emerges from a grammar that prioritizes speech restriction signals and treats harm claims with high evidentiary thresholds.

Grammar C Processing (Market-Competition Political Economy)

The competition grammar treats social media primarily as **economic infrastructures governed by incentive structures**. The foundational signal here is market concentration (Signal 3). A small number of firms dominate digital advertising markets and attention economies, producing powerful network effects.

Within this framework, the Cambridge Analytica episode (Signal 1) illustrates not just governance failure but the economic logic of data extraction. Platforms maximize data collection because targeted advertising generates revenue.

Algorithmic recommendation systems (Signal 4) are interpreted through incentive structures. Engagement-driven algorithms exist because **attention maximization increases advertising value**. Whether the resulting content is polarizing or benign is secondary; the key causal mechanism is economic optimization.

Election interference (Signal 2) and misinformation become **side effects of engagement incentives**. Content that provokes strong emotional responses spreads faster, regardless of its accuracy.

Contested Signal 1—algorithmic amplification of extremism—fits naturally into this grammar. Even if platforms do not intentionally promote extremism, engagement-based ranking systems create conditions where sensational content receives disproportionate visibility.

Youth mental health correlations (Signal 9) also connect to the attention economy. Platforms compete for user attention, encouraging prolonged usage through design features such as infinite scrolling and recommendation loops.

Transparency reports (Signal 5) are interpreted strategically. Platforms disclose moderation statistics partly to maintain regulatory legitimacy while preserving proprietary control over algorithmic systems.

The EU Digital Services Act (Signal 6) is analyzed as a **regulatory intervention within concentrated markets**. Compliance costs may reinforce the dominance of large firms that can afford regulatory infrastructure.

Section 230 debates (Signal 7) are viewed less as speech issues and more as liability structures shaping platform business models.

Decentralized platforms (Signal 11) represent a potential structural shift. If interoperability protocols reduce network effects, market power may fragment.

Public trust decline (Signal 12) signals reputational risk but does not fundamentally alter incentive structures unless it affects user behavior or advertising revenue.

Counter-Signal C—positive social media effects such as community formation—fits comfortably in this grammar because market systems often produce mixed outcomes. The key analytical question is not whether benefits exist but **whether incentive structures align with societal interests**.

Counterpoint within the grammar

Some economists argue that network effects produce efficiency benefits and that breaking up platforms could reduce innovation or user experience quality.

Closure produced by Grammar C

Social media harms are largely **emergent properties of attention-economy incentives within highly concentrated markets**. Structural interventions—competition policy, interoperability, alternative business models—are more effective than content-level regulation.

This closure emerges from a grammar that prioritizes economic incentives and market structure.

Section 5: Closure Comparison

Closure Content

Each grammar produces a distinct diagnosis and policy orientation.

Governance grammar concludes that **systemic harms require regulatory oversight**.

Libertarian grammar concludes that **speech freedom risks dominate**.

Competition grammar concludes that **market incentives are the root cause**.

Thus identical signals generate three different prescriptions:

- regulation and transparency
- minimal regulation
- structural market reform

Signal Divergence

Although the grammars share many signals, they emphasize different ones.

Governance grammar prioritizes:

- election interference
- mental health research
- algorithmic amplification

Libertarian grammar prioritizes:

- deplatforming decisions
- moderation statistics
- government removal requests

Competition grammar prioritizes:

- market concentration
- advertising incentives
- network effects.

Exclusion Patterns

Each grammar suppresses certain signals.

Governance grammar downplays censorship anecdotes.

Libertarian grammar downplays harm correlations.

Competition grammar downplays normative speech debates.

These exclusion rules are essential to how the grammars maintain internal coherence.

Causal Architecture

Each grammar constructs different causal chains.

Governance grammar:

Platform design → amplification → societal harm → regulatory necessity.

Libertarian grammar:

Regulatory pressure → moderation expansion → speech suppression → democratic risk.

Competition grammar:

Market concentration → engagement incentives → algorithmic amplification → social outcomes.

Closure Range

Governance grammar allows **moderate to strong regulatory closures**.

Libertarian grammar allows only **minimal intervention closures**.

Competition grammar allows **structural market interventions** but not heavy content regulation.

Closure Timing

Libertarian grammar often reaches closure **quickly** because its primary variable—speech restriction—is clearly observable.

Governance grammar requires **more interpretive integration of contested signals**, delaying closure.

Competition grammar reaches closure relatively confidently when market concentration evidence is accepted.

Ontological Check

The grammars may not be analyzing the same object.

- Governance grammar studies **platforms as socio-technical risk infrastructures**.
- Libertarian grammar studies **platforms as speech venues**.
- Competition grammar studies **platforms as economic markets**.

Thus the shared term “social media regulation” conceals **three different ontologies**.

Section 6: Counter-Signals, Leakage, and Stress Test

Consolidated Counter-Signals

Key counter-signals include:

- Limited measurable misinformation exposure.

- Moderation errors and bias.
- Positive social media benefits.
- Government overreach risks.

These signals create friction within each grammar.

Leakage Instances

Leakage occurs when suppressed signals reappear indirectly.

Examples:

- Governance grammar importing competition concerns when regulation risks entrenching incumbents.
- Libertarian grammar acknowledging algorithmic design influences.
- Competition grammar recognizing democratic harms beyond market incentives.

Grammar Stress Test

Governance Grammar Threat

Most threatening signal: **limited causal evidence linking misinformation to election outcomes**.

If harms are not empirically large, regulatory justification weakens. Governance grammar absorbs this by emphasizing systemic vulnerability rather than measured harm.

Libertarian Grammar Threat

Most threatening signal: **evidence of algorithmic amplification of harmful content**.

If platforms actively shape discourse, the claim that they merely host speech weakens. Some libertarian scholars respond by advocating neutrality mandates or interoperability.

Competition Grammar Threat

Most threatening signal: **evidence that harms occur even in decentralized platforms**.

If decentralization does not reduce harmful amplification, market-structure explanations weaken. This could force integration with governance-risk frameworks.

Section 7: Post-Analysis Reflexive Note

My predicted home grammar—governance-risk institutionalism—did indeed feel the most natural. The signal processing within that grammar required the least effort because it aligns with contemporary digital policy discourse emphasizing platform accountability and democratic resilience.

The most difficult grammar to inhabit was the libertarian free-speech grammar. Maintaining its high evidentiary threshold for harm claims required intentionally suspending precautionary reasoning. This exercise revealed how strongly different interpretive architectures rely on **implicit risk tolerances**.

One blind spot I initially underestimated was the explanatory power of the competition grammar. By focusing on incentive structures, it integrates many signals—algorithmic amplification, mental health effects, and misinformation—into a single causal architecture rooted in economic design. This approach avoids some normative disputes about speech while still explaining systemic outcomes.

Another unexpected observation was the **ontological divergence** between grammars. They do not merely disagree about policy; they often analyze different objects. Governance grammar studies systemic risk infrastructures, libertarian grammar studies speech environments, and competition grammar studies economic markets. Because the objects differ, debates between communities often appear irresolvable.

If the analysis began from a libertarian home grammar, the signal set itself might change dramatically. Signals like moderation errors, government speech pressure, and viewpoint discrimination would likely expand, while mental health correlations or algorithmic amplification studies might be treated as peripheral.

The exercise reveals that interpretive architectures shape not only conclusions but **what counts as evidence, how uncertainty is handled, and what risks are prioritized**.

Section 8: Methodological Observations

The Mark 2 refinements to the Prismatic Method appear to significantly improve analytical clarity.

The integration of **counter-signals during signal processing** was particularly valuable. Instead of relegating contradictions to a final critique, this requirement forced each grammar to actively negotiate tension while constructing its narrative. This revealed how grammars stabilize themselves despite ambiguous evidence.

The **temporal orientation parameter** also proved useful. Governance grammar tends to be forward-looking and precautionary, libertarian grammar often references historical constitutional principles, and competition grammar focuses on structural causal analysis. These orientations subtly influence how signals are interpreted.

The **grammar boundary specification** helped clarify that grammars can transform into one another when core variables shift. For instance, governance arguments often evolve into competition arguments when systemic harm is attributed to market concentration rather than regulatory absence.

The **stress test mechanism** was another strong addition. Identifying the single most threatening counter-signal exposes the fragility or resilience of each interpretive architecture.

The **ontological check** revealed perhaps the most important insight: many policy debates persist because participants are not analyzing the same phenomenon. The term “social media regulation” masks distinct objects of analysis.

Difficulties encountered included determining which signals should be classified as contested. In highly politicized domains, the evidentiary status of research itself becomes part of the interpretive struggle.

One refinement for future versions might involve a **signal-confidence scoring system**, allowing analysts to mark empirical robustness independently of grammar processing.

Another potential improvement would be a **cross-grammar dialogue stage**, where grammars explicitly critique each other's causal chains rather than merely producing separate closures.

Overall, the v2.0 method effectively demonstrates how identical empirical environments can generate divergent truths when processed through different interpretive grammars.